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Franklin & Marshall College Poll: June 2026

Summary of Findings

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Key Findings

The June 2026 Franklin & Marshall College Poll finds that the state's registered voters are deeply concerned about their personal finances and are increasingly dissatisfied with President Trump's performance. More voters believe the state is "on the wrong track" (47%) than believe it is "headed in the right direction" (36%). The last time a majority of registered voters believed the state was headed in the right direction was January 2020. Nearly half (47%) of respondents say they are "worse off" financially than a year ago, an increase from two in five (36%) respondents in the March 2026 F&M Poll who felt "worse off." Voters report the economy (35%), including unemployment, housing and real estate costs, and higher gas and utility prices, is the most important problem facing the state. Among those who mention economic problems, Democrats lead Republicans as the party that can best handle the issue, 42% to 24%. The economy is the top mentioned concern of every partisan group.

Governor Shapiro's job approval ratings are holding up pretty well considering how much pessimism voters express. About the same number of voters believe he is doing an "excellent" or "good" job (48%) as governor as believe he is doing a "fair" or "poor" job (48%). Governor Shapiro currently leads his Republican challenger, Stacy Garrity, 50% to 28% in the 2026 governor's race.

Fewer voters believe President Trump is doing an "excellent" or "good" job (29%) as president than believe he is doing a "fair" or "poor" job (71%), which is a sizable decline since our March poll when his positive approval rating was 39%. His positive approval ratings declined within every partisan group. The president's approval ratings for his specific policy actions around immigration, foreign affairs, and inflation have all declined since October. His administration's handling of inflation fell from 31% positive in October to 17% positive today.

Detailed Findings

Direction of State and Personal Finances

More registered voters believe the state is "on the wrong track" (47%) than believe it is "headed in the right direction" (36%). The last time a majority of registered voters believed the state was headed in the right direction was January 2020. Nearly half (47%) of respondents say they are "worse off" financially than a year ago, an increase from two in five (36%) respondents in the March 2026 F&M Poll. More than half of Democrats and independent voters say they are "worse off" financially than last year, as do 30% of Republicans (see Table A-1). The share of voters who say they are "worse off" is at its highest point since August 2024. More voters expect to be "worse off" financially next year (32%) than expect to be "better off" (19%), which is a much more pessimistic assessment than in March. Voters have been more pessimistic than optimistic about their personal financial circumstances since October 2020 (see Figure 1).

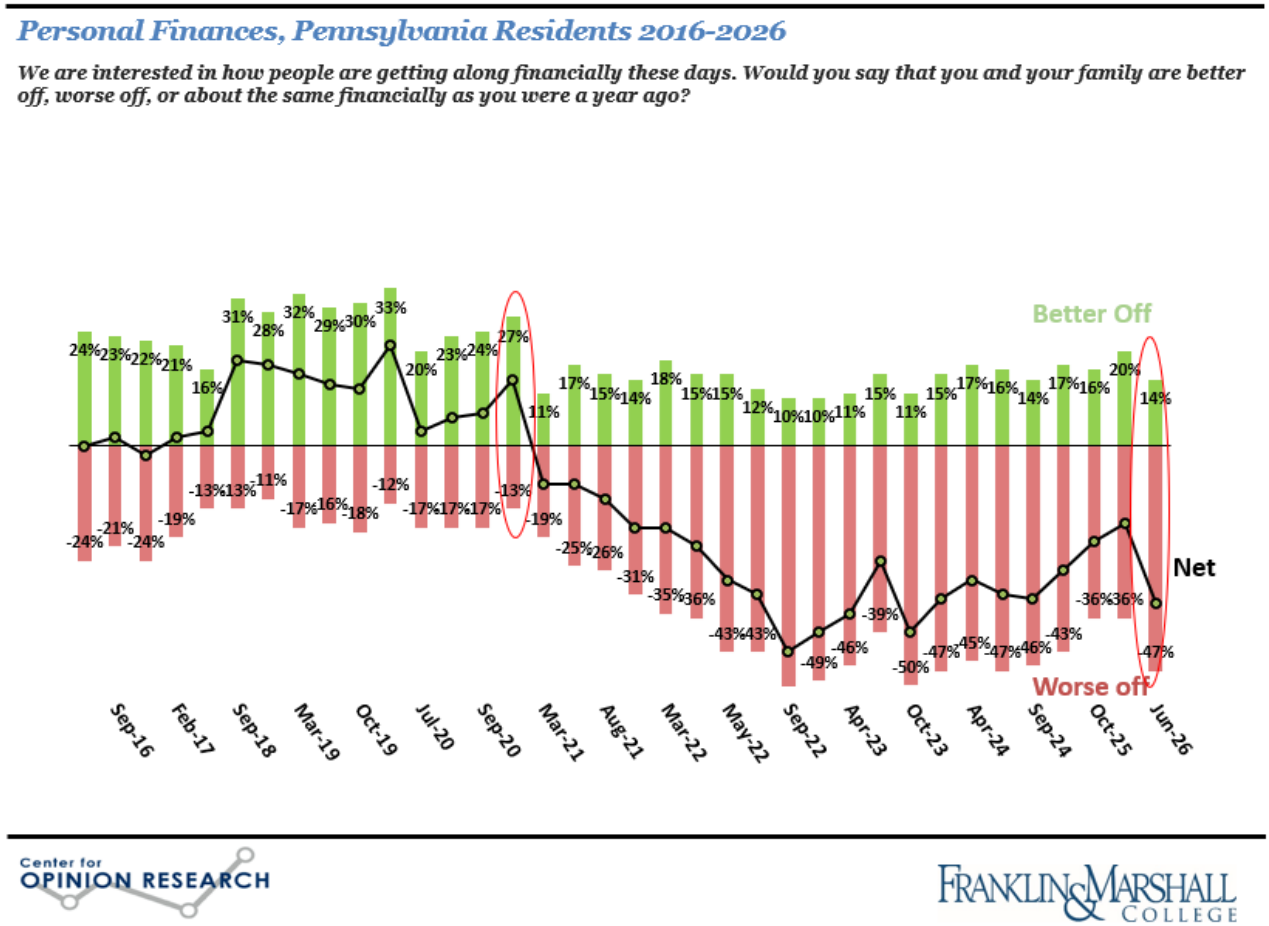


Figure 1. *This figure shows how Pennsylvania's registered voters assess their personal financial circumstances.*

Voters report the economy (35%), including unemployment, housing and real estate costs, and higher gas and utility prices, is the most important problem facing the state. The economy is the top concern of every partisan group (Democrats (38%), independents (35%), Republicans (34%)). Concern about government and politics (14%), the top concern last October, is mentioned less often than the economy as the top problem. Among those who mention economic problems, Democrats lead Republicans as the party that can best handle the issue, 42% to 24%, which is about the same advantage for Democrats as in March.

State Politics

Governor Shapiro's job approval ratings are holding up pretty well considering how much pessimism voters express. About the same number of voters believe he is doing an "excellent" or "good" job (48%) as governor as believe he is doing a "fair" or "poor" job (48%). Three in four Democrats, almost half of independents, and just over a quarter of Republicans rate the governor's performance as "excellent" or "good" (see Table A-2). Governor Shapiro currently leads his Republican challenger, Stacy Garrity, 50% to 28%, in the 2026 governor's race.

The survey included questions about four state policy issues and found broad consensus about the policy ideas tested.

- There is widespread support (89%) for limiting access to cell phones in schools.
- Seven in ten (72%) registered voters favor a state law that makes it illegal to discriminate in employment or housing based on a person's sexual orientation or gender identity. Voters have consistently favored such a law since the question was first asked in 2014.
- Seven in ten (71%) registered voters favor regulating and taxing skill games, which is an increase in support since 2024 (60% favored).
- Seven in ten (70%) registered voters support having an independent redistricting commission draw state legislative districts. Most (59%) voters say they oppose the mid-decade redistricting that is currently taking place in some states.

Presidential Ratings

Fewer voters believe President Trump is doing an "excellent" or "good" job (29%) as president than believe he is doing a "fair" or "poor" job (71%), which is a sizable decline since our March poll when his positive approval rating was 39%. If President Trump's net approval ratings do not rise, his party will enter the mid-terms with lower presidential approval ratings than any of his predecessors, including his ratings during his first mid-term election in 2018 (see Figure 2). Two in three Republicans, one in seven independents, and only one in twenty Democrats rate the president's job performance as "excellent" or "good" (see Table A-3), which represents a decline in ratings among every partisan group. Democrats currently lead Republicans by 12 points, 47% to 35%, in voters' preferences for the US House of Representatives.

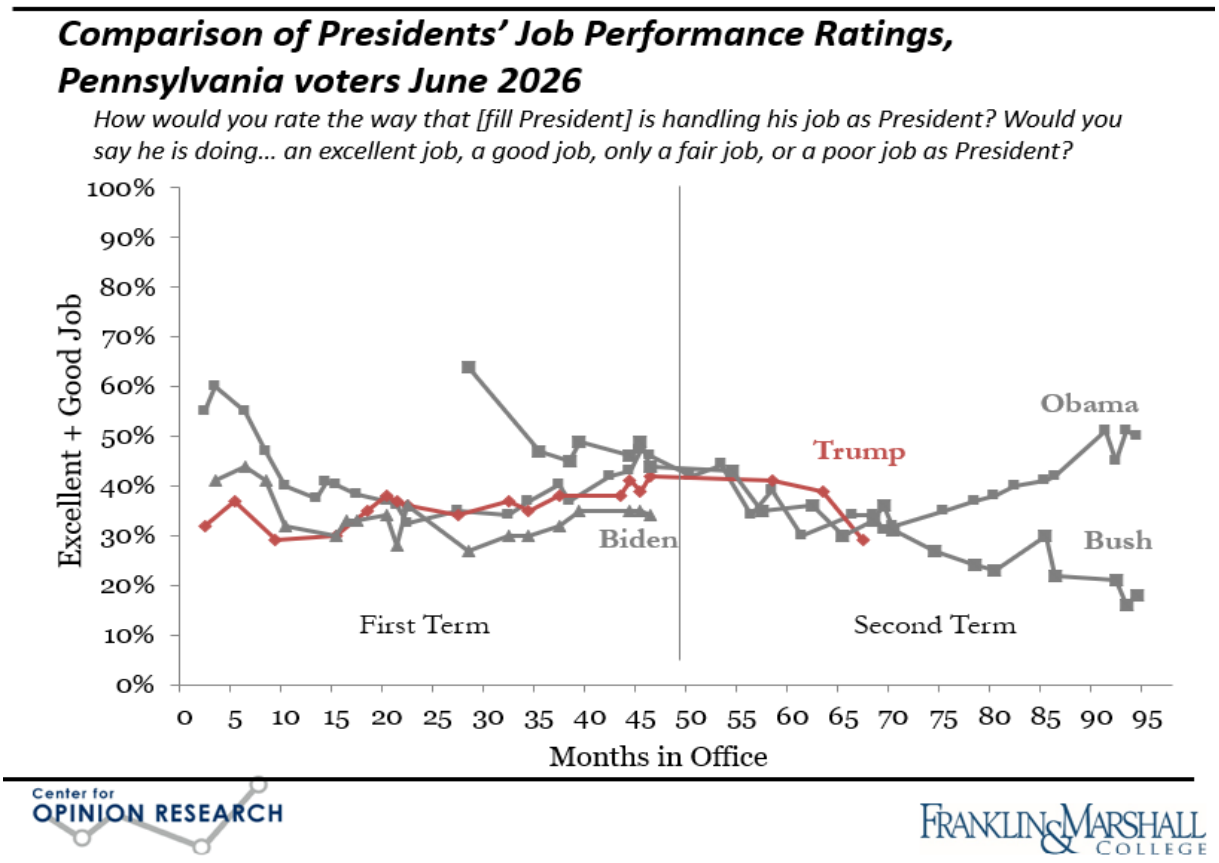


Figure 2. *This figure shows approval ratings among Pennsylvania voters for recent presidents in relation to their months in office.*

The president's approval ratings for his specific policy actions around immigration, foreign affairs, and inflation have declined since October. The Trump administration ratings for dealing with immigration slid from 47% "excellent" or "very good" in October to 39% now. The administration's rating for handling foreign policy matters has declined from 42% to 29%. His largest declines come in his administration's handling of inflation, falling from 31% positive in October to 17% today.

Good government advocates often suggest that some of the Trump Administration's practices and policies have harmed public perceptions of government accountability. This survey found that the proportion of the state's registered voters who agree that the federal government has little corruption and that its operations are open and transparent have changed little since the Biden Administration. But it is notable that the share of voters who "strongly disagree" with those statements has increased significantly since 2021: 73% today compared to 57% in 2021 "strongly disagree" there is little corruption in the federal government and 62% today compared to 44% in 2021 "strongly disagree" that government operations are open and transparent.

Table 1 shows a set of political indicators for recent presidents that provides a useful framework for thinking about the upcoming mid-term races. These indicators show that Democrats are in a relatively strong political position at the moment, with President Trump's approval rating being among the lowest of any recent president and having a sizable advantage on the generic ballot question. Democrats (64%) are currently more likely than Republicans (51%) to say they are "very interested" in the upcoming elections.

Table 1. Selected Political Mid-Term Indicators, Pennsylvania

	Oct 2006	Oct 2010	Oct 2014	Oct 2018	Oct 2022	June 2026
Pennsylvania headed in right direction	47%	27%	28%	51%	28%	36%
Most important problem	--	Economy	Education	Government Education Economy	Economy Government Crime	Economy Government
Presidential job approval rating *(% excellent + good)*	Bush: 31%	Obama: 32%	Obama: 32%	Trump 36%	Biden 36%	Trump 29%
Generic ballot *(Democrat candidate % - Republican candidate %)*	--	+4 R	+ 6 D	+15 D	+5 R	+12 D
Party Identification *(Democrat ID % - Republican ID %)*	+5 D	+2 R	+6 D	+11 D	+ 4 R	even
Party Control (seat changes in PA)						
US House	D (+4)	R (+5)	R (0)	E (D + 4)	D (R -1)	
State House	D (+9)	R (+13)	R (+ 9)	R (D +11)	D (+ 9)	
State Senate	R (D +1)	R (0)	R (+3)	R (D +5)	R (D +1)	

Methodology

The survey findings presented in this release are based on the results of interviews conducted June 8 – 14, 2026. The interviews were conducted at the Center for Opinion Research at Franklin & Marshall College. The data included in this release represent the responses of 546 registered Pennsylvania voters, including 233 Democrats, 226 Republicans, and 87 independents.[1] The sample of voters was obtained from Aristotle. All sampled respondents were notified by mail about the survey. Interviews were completed over the phone and online depending on each respondent's preference. Survey results were weighted (age, gender, education, geography, vote history, and party registration) using an iterative weighting algorithm to reflect the known distribution of those characteristics. Estimates for age, geography, and party registration are based on active voters within the Pennsylvania Department of State's voter registration data. Gender and education are estimated using data from the November 2022 CPS Voter Registration Supplement. This poll was supported by a gift from F&M alumnus Brett Harwood, Class of '71.

The sample error for this survey is +/- 5.1 percentage points when the design effects from weighting are considered. The sample error for questions based on subgroups is larger. An alternative means of calculating the variation in a sample is to take a series of bootstrap samples from the original sample and to use those bootstrapped samples to produce an estimate of sampling error. The procedure involves resampling a data set, calculating a statistic for each bootstrapped sample, accumulating the results of these samples, and calculating a sample distribution. The standard deviation of the mean of 10,000 bootstrapped samples for President

[1] The data reported here is voter REGISTRATION and is consistent with past reporting practices. The survey also asked about self-reported voter IDENTIFICATION, which shows a slightly different partisan split: 43% identify as Republican (n=221), 9% as independent (n=48), and 43% as Democrat (n=222) and the balance not offering a response. Partisan comparisons in this summary show self-reported registration.

Trump's positive job approval ratings was 1.9%, and 95% of the samples fell within a range of 25% and 33%.

In addition to sampling error, this poll is also subject to other sources of non-sampling error. Generally speaking, two sources of error concern researchers most. Non-response bias is created when selected participants either choose not to participate in the survey or are unavailable for interviewing. Response errors are the product of the question and answer process. Surveys that rely on self-reported behaviors and attitudes are susceptible to biases related to the way respondents process and respond to survey questions.

Questions from the Public about our Polling

Q: Do you require your final sample to have specific numbers of people in certain groups, for example, do you use quotas for age, party, or region?

- The Franklin & Marshall College Poll does not use quotas, meaning we do not specify ahead of time how many people from each group is in our sample, although we may do more non-response outreach with groups that are underrepresented in our pool of completes.

Q: What proportion of interviews are conducted by calling cellphones? What are the overall percentages who completed the survey online and by phone?

- The Franklin & Marshall College Poll uses a mixed mode approach, which means that a person can respond over the telephone or online. One-fifth (n=119) of the completed interviews in this poll were completed over the phone. All of the telephone completes were identified as cell phones.

Q: Many people complete your surveys online. What measures do you take to make sure they are attentive and real people, not bots?

- We review the responses of every survey participant and compute an attentiveness score for each completed interview, whether completed online or on the telephone. For this survey, attentiveness scoring includes measuring the amount of time the respondent spent in the main body of the survey questionnaire, coding the quality of open-ended responses (did the response relate to the question, was it clear, was it coherent); and computing the total number of missing and don't know responses.

Q: Do you send any additional mailers or do other reminders to people who don't respond to your postcard invitation? How does non-response affect your surveys?

- The Franklin & Marshall College Poll's outreach to our sample always begins with a postcard mailer. Follow up outreach includes phone calls, emails, and text messages wherever that information is available. We will do up to four phone calls, two texts, and two emails (emails are not available for all respondents). Every respondent in our sample receives a unique ID they must use to complete a survey. We also do some non-response assessment from time to time so that people who care about that can see it (for example, here is an assessment of our 2022 polling), and we always calculate bootstrapped sample error estimates in addition to the traditional estimates.

Q: How do you handle the "someone else" and "do not know" responses for respondents taking the survey online?

- "Other" and "do not know" options appear on screen for the online surveys. "Do not know" is not read to phone participants and isn't included in the online question text but is accepted when offered.

Q: What is Aristotle and what gives you confidence that you have a representative sample?

- The way the Franklin & Marshall College Poll is conducted is sound because we follow best practices in our industry. We draw a random sample of voters from Aristotle, which is a company that many pollsters use to provide their samples (you can read more about them here). We then send a postcard to everyone in our sample letting them know we will be calling them, after which we follow up with phone calls, text messages, and emails depending on what kind of contact information is included for each voter. Survey participants can do the survey over the telephone or complete it online based on whichever method is more convenient. So we feel confident in the way we gather our data because we encourage participation and offer people lots of opportunities to participate.

Q: What's going on with party identification in your samples? In your subsets it seems like you oversampled Democrats.

- The question about party identification is important. Pennsylvania is one of those states where you need to be registered in a party at least 15 days prior to an election to vote and most voters in the state are registered as either Republicans or Democrats. You can get voter registration figures from the state's web site, which is here. If you go to that page and download the statistics, you will find that 42% of the state's active voters are registered as Democrats, 42% are registered as Republicans, and the rest (16%) are registered with a third party. If you compare the party breakdown in our samples you'll find that it matches those figures exactly, so we have the right partisan balance within our data. We write a lot about partisanship in the state (a list of some of those articles is here). It is worth noting that party registration, which we report, is not necessarily the same as party identification, something explained here.

Q: Many states' polls show different issues being most important to voters, why are your results different?

- There are many ways to ask about issues. Our approach is simply to ask a question at the beginning of the survey about the most important problem facing the state today. Survey participants can say whatever comes to mind, after which we put their responses into categories. In this and other recent polls, the economy, education, and politicians are at the top of the list. Other pollsters give people lists of issues and ask people to rate each one or to select one issue from their list; it is often these formats that produce responses that differ from ours. We are not suggesting that one approach is better than the other, just that they tend to produce different results.

Table A-1: Personal Finances

Pennsylvania registered voters, June 2026

We are interested in how people are getting along financially these days. Would you say that you and your family are better off, worse off, or about the same financially as you were a year ago?

	Better off	Worse off	About the same
Party*			
Republican	20%	30%	51%
Democrat	10%	55%	35%
Independent or Something Else	12%	55%	34%
Ideology*			
Liberal	12%	53%	36%
Moderate	11%	59%	29%
Conservative	17%	27%	55%
Gender			
Female	14%	50%	36%
Male	13%	44%	43%
Age*			
Under 35	12%	56%	32%
35-54	16%	53%	31%
Over 55	13%	38%	48%
Education**			
HS or less	12%	44%	44%
Some college	8%	55%	37%
College degree	18%	42%	40%
Race			
White	15%	45%	40%
Nonwhite	7%	56%	37%
Race & Education, White Voters			
White, No College Degree	12%	48%	41%
White, College Degree	19%	41%	40%
Income*			
Under $35,000	9%	69%	22%
$35,000-$75,000	15%	54%	31%
Over $75,000	15%	42%	43%
"Born-again" or evangelical Christian			
Yes	18%	38%	44%
No	14%	49%	38%
Region			
Philadelphia & Southeast	13%	48%	39%
Northeast	9%	64%	26%
Allegheny & Southwest	15%	42%	43%
Northwest	18%	49%	33%
Central	15%	39%	46%
Urban-Rural Classification*			
Large Central Metro	16%	52%	32%
Large Fringe Metro	12%	43%	45%
Medium Metro	13%	50%	37%
Small Metro	16%	48%	36%
Micropolitan	9%	30%	60%
Noncore	39%	56%	5%

*$p<0.01$ **$p<0.05$

Table A-2: Gubernatorial Performance

Pennsylvania registered voters, June 2026

How would you rate the way that Josh Shapiro is handling his job as governor? Would you say he is doing an excellent job, a good job, only a fair job, or a poor job as governor?

	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor	Do not know
Party*					
Republican	4%	22%	37%	34%	4%
Democrat	38%	38%	10%	11%	2%
Independent or Something Else	11%	32%	37%	16%	4%
Ideology*					
Liberal	33%	41%	12%	13%	1%
Moderate	24%	36%	24%	10%	6%
Conservative	3%	16%	34%	44%	2%
Gender**					
Female	23%	30%	23%	22%	2%
Male	14%	28%	26%	25%	7%
Age*					
Under 35	7%	28%	31%	23%	10%
35-54	21%	27%	22%	24%	6%
Over 55	22%	31%	23%	23%	1%
Education*					
HS or less	11%	25%	29%	33%	2%
Some college	12%	30%	23%	27%	7%
College degree	27%	29%	24%	17%	3%
Race					
White	20%	28%	24%	23%	4%
Nonwhite	12%	33%	25%	26%	5%
Race & Education, White Voters*					
White, No College Degree	13%	26%	26%	30%	5%
White, College Degree	28%	30%	23%	16%	3%
Income					
Under $35,000	6%	28%	36%	30%	0%
$35,000-$75,000	18%	33%	26%	22%	2%
Over $75,000	22%	30%	23%	19%	6%
"Born-again" or evangelical Christian**					
Yes	13%	18%	42%	25%	2%
No	21%	32%	20%	23%	4%
Region*					
Philadelphia & Southeast	22%	32%	23%	18%	4%
Northeast	17%	40%	10%	19%	14%
Allegheny & Southwest	24%	22%	28%	24%	2%
Northwest	14%	33%	22%	30%	1%
Central	12%	23%	31%	31%	3%
Urban-Rural Classification*					
Large Central Metro	27%	33%	22%	13%	5%
Large Fringe Metro	21%	28%	26%	22%	3%
Medium Metro	15%	32%	20%	25%	8%
Small Metro	9%	27%	24%	41%	0%
Micropolitan	15%	18%	38%	29%	0%
Noncore	4%	4%	50%	39%	2%

** p<0.01 ** p<0.05*

Table A-3: Presidential Performance

Pennsylvania registered voters, June 2026

How would you rate the way that Donald Trump is handling his job as president? Would you say he is doing an excellent job, a good job, only a fair job, or a poor job as President?

	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor
Party*				
Republican	*23%*	*40%*	*19%*	*17%*
Democrat	*2%*	*3%*	*5%*	*90%*
Independent or Something Else	*8%*	*7%*	*17%*	*68%*
Ideology*				
Liberal	*0%*	*3%*	*0%*	*97%*
Moderate	*6%*	*11%*	*15%*	*69%*
Conservative	*28%*	*34%*	*19%*	*16%*
Gender				
Female	*14%*	*16%*	*11%*	*57%*
Male	*10%*	*17%*	*14%*	*59%*
Age*				
Under 35	*4%*	*7%*	*14%*	*76%*
35-54	*9%*	*14%*	*15%*	*62%*
Over 55	*17%*	*23%*	*11%*	*48%*
Education*				
HS or less	*14%*	*25%*	*14%*	*47%*
Some college	*13%*	*22%*	*12%*	*52%*
College degree	*10%*	*9%*	*12%*	*66%*
Race				
White	*12%*	*18%*	*12%*	*57%*
Nonwhite	*12%*	*8%*	*15%*	*64%*
Race & Education, White Voters*				
White, No College Degree	*14%*	*25%*	*13%*	*47%*
White, College Degree	*10%*	*10%*	*11%*	*67%*
Income				
Under $35,000	*10%*	*12%*	*20%*	*58%*
$35,000-$75,000	*14%*	*18%*	*8%*	*60%*
Over $75,000	*11%*	*16%*	*8%*	*64%*
"Born-again" or evangelical Christian*				
Yes	*21%*	*31%*	*23%*	*23%*
No	*10%*	*13%*	*10%*	*66%*
Region*				
Philadelphia & Southeast	*8%*	*11%*	*12%*	*66%*
Northeast	*7%*	*8%*	*15%*	*67%*
Allegheny & Southwest	*14%*	*17%*	*7%*	*63%*
Northwest	*9%*	*28%*	*13%*	*51%*
Central	*18%*	*23%*	*16%*	*42%*
Urban-Rural Classification*				
Large Central Metro	*8%*	*7%*	*7%*	*77%*
Large Fringe Metro	*10%*	*17%*	*12%*	*58%*
Medium Metro	*12%*	*20%*	*12%*	*56%*
Small Metro	*15%*	*21%*	*24%*	*40%*
Micropolitan	*18%*	*24%*	*16%*	*42%*
Noncore	*41%*	*0%*	*32%*	*27%*

** p<0.01 ** p<0.05*

Table A-4: President Trump's Performance: Dealing with Inflation

Pennsylvania registered voters, June 2026

Using an A for excellent, B for very good, C for average, D for below average or F for failing – how well has President Trump's administration performed…Dealing with inflation?

	A=Excellent	B=Very good	C=Average	D=Below average	F=Failing	Do not know
Party*						
Republican	9%	26%	33%	17%	14%	0%
Democrat	1%	1%	6%	11%	81%	0%
Independent or Something Else	4%	3%	23%	12%	57%	0%
Ideology*						
Liberal	0%	1%	6%	7%	87%	0%
Moderate	3%	6%	13%	16%	62%	0%
Conservative	9%	27%	37%	16%	11%	1%
Gender						
Female	7%	10%	17%	12%	54%	1%
Male	3%	13%	20%	13%	49%	1%
Age*						
Under 35	0%	6%	15%	16%	62%	0%
35-54	4%	8%	15%	13%	58%	2%
Over 55	7%	16%	22%	11%	42%	1%
Education*						
HS or less	6%	7%	36%	10%	40%	0%
Some college	3%	19%	14%	11%	51%	2%
College degree	5%	8%	14%	15%	56%	1%
Race						
White	4%	12%	19%	13%	50%	1%
Nonwhite	7%	10%	16%	11%	56%	0%
Race & Education, White Voters*						
White, No College Degree	5%	14%	24%	12%	44%	2%
White, College Degree	4%	9%	13%	15%	58%	1%
Income						
Under $35,000	1%	8%	22%	15%	54%	0%
$35,000-$75,000	6%	13%	16%	13%	52%	0%
Over $75,000	3%	11%	18%	13%	54%	0%
"Born-again" or evangelical Christian*						
Yes	12%	18%	35%	11%	23%	1%
No	4%	10%	15%	13%	58%	1%
Region*						
Philadelphia & Southeast	4%	6%	19%	9%	61%	1%
Northeast	5%	9%	8%	21%	56%	1%
Allegheny & Southwest	4%	19%	10%	10%	57%	0%
Northwest	9%	13%	12%	23%	42%	0%
Central	5%	14%	30%	13%	37%	2%
Urban-Rural Classification*						
Large Central Metro	6%	5%	11%	4%	74%	0%
Large Fringe Metro	3%	13%	20%	13%	51%	1%
Medium Metro	4%	11%	21%	15%	47%	2%
Small Metro	8%	9%	18%	28%	37%	0%
Micropolitan	9%	22%	19%	17%	33%	0%
Noncore	3%	39%	32%	0%	27%	0%

** p<0.01 ** p<0.05*